Parent Participatory Action Research Curriculum Draft

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Community perspective has been incorporated into research through school and youth voices; however, little research has incorporated the voices and experiences of parents.[1]

Background

- The goal of Project TRUST II is to address critical social determinants of health and adolescent behavioral health issues through a focus on school connectedness and environment. For more information on TRUST II, go to: (http://z.umn.edu/projecttrust).
- The purpose of this project is to obtain parent feedback on a parent participatory action research (PPAR) curriculum draft to be used in the Project TRUST II Intervention.

Research Question

What are parents' perceptions of a Parent Participatory Action Research (PPAR) curriculum draft?

Methodology

Approach

- Community Based Participatory Action Research (CBPAR) "*sees disenfranchised communities as keepers of critical social knowledge with full capabilities of being both the "subjects and architects of research"*[2]

Participant Criteria

- Parent of child in middle or high school in the Saint Paul Public Schools District
- Speaks English
- Self-identify as Somali, Latino, Hmong, or African American/other African Heritage

Procedure

- Compiled Table of Contents for PPAR curriculum (**Figure 1**)
- Developed interview questions (**Figure 2**)
- Conducted 2 of 4 interviews
- Securely recorded interviews
- Hand written notes
- Analyzed Data (**Figure 3**)

Table of Contents
Overview of Project TRUST
CBPAR
Team Building
Communication
Intensive Research Training
Recruitment
Dissemination
Policy Change

Figure 1: PPAR Curriculum Draft

Interview Question Domains
1) Preparation: What additional components may be missing in adequately preparing parents for research?
2) Approach: How appropriate is the language and content for parents across all educational backgrounds?
3) Manageability/Engagement: How can we make the curriculum interesting and still practical?

Figure 2: Question domains for parent interviews

Preliminary Results

Themes	Quotes
Audience	"Well my English is not that good, you know, my reading English… I can read but then if I don't understand the word, I'll be like 'oh, what does that mean?'"
Delivery Ideas	"When we talk about team building, I really don't, in my experience, like to be taught and lectured about how to be a team....I would think of fun team building activities. Let's each bring a game from our backgrounds."
Content Adjustment	"I would say communication: working with each other, talking with school board/principal, working with your child. I think that would be the best one for me."
Logistics	"…Have realistic deadlines cause parents are crazy busy. Even myself, I don't even know if I can participate in something like this even though I'm (in) academic background."

Figure 3: General themes and direct quotations from 2 parent interviews

Discussion

- Parents displayed a general interest in the PPAR curriculum but showed concern with proposed time commitment.
- A convenience sampling method was used to gather participants for interviews. Two of four parents have been interviewed thus far. The diversity in thoughts, experiences, and opinions of Somali, Latino, Hmong, and African American/other African Heritage communities are not fully captured in this study because the sampling size was small.
- There's a need for further academic and community collaboration with parents using a CBPAR approach. CBPAR helps to restore relationships between parents and schools.
- PPAR provides a different way to involve/engage parents in schools.

Next Steps

- Conduct and analyze 2 additional parent interviews
- Complete development of PPAR curriculum
- Discuss best practices for facilitation methods

References

[1] McNeal RB. Parental Involvement as Social Capital: Differential Effectiveness on Science Achievement, Truancy, and Dropping Out. *Soc. Forces.* 1999;78(1):117-144.

[2] Fuentes E. Learning Power and Building Community: Parent-Initiated Participatory Action Research as a Tool for Organizing Community. Social Justice. 2009;36(4 (118)):69-83.

Acknowledgement and Gratitude

PROJECT TRUST
The College of Education & Human Development, University of Minnesota
University of Minnesota Medical School
West Side Community Health Services
TRIO Ronald E. McNair Post-Baccalaureate Achievement Program
University of Minnesota